

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, November 8, 2017, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present were:

Ward I Councilor Carolyn Towle
Ward II Councilor Scott Pope
At-Large Councilor Keith Raymond (late)
Assistant Mayor Allen Damren
Mayor Charlene Lovett
Ward III Councilor Nicholas Koloski
At-Large Councilor John Simonds

Absent:

At-Large Councilor Abigail Kier
At-Large Councilor Bruce Temple

Also present:

Ryan McNutt, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

Mayor Lovett asked to suspend Council Rule 24, Filing with Clerk, to discuss NHDES Local Water Source Protection Grant application. It had recently come available and was not on the agenda. Council concurred to suspend the rule.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

Mayor Lovett said she is still waiting for information about the public portion of the Non-Public Session in order to complete the minutes of the July 12, 2017, City Council meeting.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Towle to accept the minutes of the October 10, 2017, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 6-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Ms. Towle to accept the minutes of the October 11, 2017, City Council meeting as amended.

Mayor Lovett said on page 8, 5th paragraph from the bottom, add after Reps first, “about a possible amendment.”

At 6:33 p.m. Mr. Raymond arrived.

Mayor Lovett said on page 12, top paragraph after the first sentence to add, “with regard to issues of a community-wide concern/impact.”

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

A motion was made by Ms. Towle and seconded by Mr. Simonds to accept the minutes of the October 19, 2017, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Simonds to accept the minutes of the October 25, 2017, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

MAYOR’S NOTES

Mayor Lovett’s notes:

- Thanked Parks and Recreation Department for Hallowesta.
- SB247 lead bill – she testified at the public hearing yesterday. Was notified today that the House passed SB247. Next step is for the House Finance Committee to make a report on November 16 to the full House and it will be voted on in January.
- Thanked everyone who came out to vote.

Mr. Koloski said on November 24th the lighting of Broad Street Park, 6-8 p.m., will take place. Ms. Towle asked to have the decorating schedule for Broad Street Park reposted.

Mr. Pope wished good luck to the Stevens High School football team in the semi-finals.

Mr. Raymond congratulated Councilor Abigail Kier and her husband on the birth of their baby boy.

Mayor Lovett reminded all that Veterans Day is Saturday. The American Legion will hold a ceremony at 11:00 a.m. in Broad Street Park. Ms. Towle said Time-out Americana Grill would be serving dinner to all veterans. Mr. Koloski said it would be 4-6 p.m. and would be free.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Mr. McNutt gave his report.

2017 Tax Rate

The 2017 tax rate was set at \$42.66 which was \$.19 less than anticipated. The average assessed home in Claremont is \$127,000 and the average tax bill for a residential property is \$5,417.82 for 2017

The city's total assessed property value is \$701 million, an increase of about \$5 million from last year due to a slowly recovering residential market.

Community and Economic Development

October 24 and November 1 NH Healthy Homes Conferences – Attended by multi-agency panel of Claremont professionals working toward the reduction of lead-based hazards in the community.

Community development staff and the Greater Claremont Chamber of Commerce facilitated a groundbreaking at the future new Ford Dealership held on November 6th.

Mr. McNutt attended the 2017 Housing and the Economy Conference by New Hampshire Housing. Shortfall of new housing has created a bottleneck. Rental vacancies nationally are 7%; Sullivan County is 2.8%. Mayor Lovett asked Mr. McNutt to give a presentation on the conference.

Parks & Recreation **CSBCC**

Hutter Construction repaired the wall behind the backboard of the basketball court using stronger material to prevent the holes that were being punched through the prior drywall.

The City DPW and Parks staff are reviewing what will be needed to add a second long-jump pit at Monadnock Park. The City is also reviewing the issue of additional safety nets for the javelin and discus events to further protect people using the track during those events.

Mr. McNutt will have Parks and Recreation Director Mark Brislin inquire into the process for Claremont to host state championships.

Public Works

Main Street & Washington Street paving with the Senate Bill 38 funds is substantially complete as of Friday, November 1st.

Trinity Street is largely completed, but still will need a top coat.

Main Street Project (NHDOT) – Construction is expected to start Spring 2018.

WWTP Solar Array – Working with ReVision Energy on construction timeline.

Winter Parking Ban is in effect November 1st through April 15th. No overnight parking will be allowed on City streets between midnight and 7 a.m.

Harm Reduction – looked into the appropriateness of having a needle exchange at the Claremont Soup Kitchen. Soup Kitchen is within the radius of the school drug free zone. They have stopped the needle exchange and are now looking for another location. Valley Regional Hospital (VRH) is in a drug free zone. VRH is looking to see if they can get an exemption. He is working with VRH and the school district to see if there is a more appropriate location.

Ms. Towle would like to know how many drug overdoses the Fire Department responds to each month. Mr. McNutt will follow-up.

Ms. Towle said the numbers are down in the Library. She asked if payroll has been adjusted for the change in hours. Mr. McNutt will follow-up.

Ms. Towle asked about salt and sand prices. Scott Sweet, Public Works Director, said salt is \$68/ton and was \$72/ton last year. They moved a lot of sand from the airport. It cost \$7,000 to screen the sand. If they run out, they will get more from LE Weed, the company that has the contract, and it will be \$7.50/ton delivered. They usually average 2,500 tons of salt per year.

Ms. Towle gave a pat on the back to Welfare because of the marked reduction of funds that have been expended for this month.

Mayor Lovett said the number of reported false calls seemed high. She asked what the cost is to the City for the false calls.

Mayor Lovett said it would be helpful to include the amount raised when a department reports a fundraiser.

Mayor Lovett said at the beginning of next year that she would like to look at the numbers for the community center; membership numbers are going down compared to what the numbers were when it opened, which is expected because the pro-forma said that would happen. She would like to see what the plan is to address that or the potential for finding revenue as the expenses go up to maintain the building.

Mayor Lovett said when the new City Council is seated, she will want a presentation from the Planning and Development Department on economic development.

Bernie Folta, Ward 3, asked about paving Washington Street in the rain and if the rainwater might freeze and cause deterioration from underneath. Mr. Sweet explained the process and said that there was no water under the pavement.

Mr. McNutt said that Ms. Towle had sent him a question by email, asking why the paving work was not done at night. He said it was due to cost and safety.

Mayor Lovett asked Mr. McNutt to send Council a copy of his City Manager's report.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Claremont Development Authority

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Towle to re-appoint Candace T. Crawford to seat 7 of the Claremont Development Authority

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. Raymond to appoint Cory LeClair to seat 8 of the Claremont Development Authority.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

Frances J. Tolles Home Trustees

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. Damren to appoint Karlaine V. Livingston to seat 2 of the Frances J. Tolles Home Trustees.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

Parks and Recreation Commission

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Raymond to appoint Robert Walker, II, to seat 5 – At Large of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

Tax Increment Finance District Advisory Board - Downtown

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Ms. Towle to appoint Alison G. Raymond to seat 1 of the Tax Increment Finance District Advisory Board - Downtown.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

No one spoke.

OLD BUSINESS

Ordinance 557 Naming City-owned Property – First Reading

The purpose of this proposed change is to establish procedures and criteria for naming city-owned property, including streets.

Enactment of this Ordinance will revise Chapter 16, by adding a new Article V, Naming of City-Owned Property.

Mr. Pope reviewed the changes. Properties located in the Historic District should go to the Historic District Commission for an opinion. Honorary street designation was removed (could be confusing). Sec. 16-113 changed "City Council may..." to "City Council should consider alternatives..." Sec. 16-111 removed "be named after a living person." Added "A living person may be considered with a 2/3 vote of the City Council."

Mr. Pope read the explanation of proposed action into the record.

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. Raymond to adopt Ordinance 557 Naming City-owned Property on First Reading.

Mr. McNutt asked if Sec. 16-111, #3, 2/3 vote was intended for 2/3 of those present or 2/3 of the full Council. Mr. Pope said it is 2/3 of those present since it is not financial.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

Discussion of Draft Fund Balance Policy

Mayor Lovett said that this had been reviewed by legal counsel and was told there are no legal issues that require modification. This does not have to be done by ordinance.

Mr. Damren said the Finance Committee (Mayor Lovett, Mr. Damren and Mr. Temple), with input from Mr. McNutt and Finance Director Mary Walter, took the existing fund balance policy and added more definitions.

Mr. Damren proposed to make a change (which the Policy Committee was not aware of) to Section 5. Unassigned Fund Balance – General Fund, C iv. He said the members of the Finance Committee disagreed on the 2/3. This terminology would hamper a vote. So, he proposed a change it to require a super majority of 2/3 of the current elected members of the City Council present at the meeting.

Mr. Damren said the old policy had an acceptable range of unassigned fund balance of between 5-15% of general fund expenditures. They raised it to 15-20% of actual general fund revenues each fiscal year which is a significant change to the policy. It would impact borrowing rates.

Mr. Pope thinks Mr. Damren's proposed change could be made by the Council and not have to go back to the Policy Committee.

There was a discussion about the two-third vote.

Ms. Walter attended the September Finance Committee meeting and she had told the Committee that there are certain times when money is taken from fund balance instead of placing the expense on the tax rate (i.e. heat for the JSL building).

Mayor Lovett said the goal is to make it somewhat difficult to pull money out of fund balance, but to also have some flexibility.

Bernie Folta, Ward 3, talked about the two-thirds vote. He suggested there may be a Roberts Rules reason for having two-thirds of those present versus two-thirds of the membership. He talked about elected members versus appointed members. He recommended it be the majority of those present.

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. Raymond to bring this policy to the Council for a vote, with the changes and reformatting recommended by legal counsel.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

NEW BUSINESS

Resolution 2018-15 Boat Launch at Wild Goose – Public Hearing

The property known as "The Wild Goose site" in Newbury, NH was purchased in November, 1990 for the expressed purpose of providing a public boat ramp on Lake Sunapee. The State of NH passed legislation (RSA 233-A) in 1992 which became effective on January 1, 1993, requiring that all bodies of water in excess of 10 acres have a public boat access ramp as specified in RSA 233-A. Lake Sunapee still has no public boat access which meets the requirements and definitions outlined in RSA 233-A. The NH Fish and Game Department, charged with implementing RSA 233-A, has obtained all the permits required by the Department of Environmental Services and all appeals in opposition to those permits have been denied. All legal appeals by project opponents have been denied. The State of NH has already invested more than \$450,000 in this project. The NH House of Representatives included in the 2018 Capital Budget an item to bond for the construction of the boat access on the Wild Goose site. The bond is to be serviced by federal matching funds and revenue from a dedicated boat access account, funded by the \$5.00 annual registration fee for all motorized boats.

Mr. Simonds read the resolution into the record.

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Mr. Raymond to adopt Resolution 2018-15 Boat Launch at Wild Goose.

Don Clarke said that property on Birch Grove Road was acquired for the purpose of building a boat ramp. In 1992, legislation was passed that every great body of water over 10 acres shall have boat access. There is a boat ramp at Georges Mills for Sunapee residents only. Sunapee Harbor has a ramp, but no parking nearby. He gave a history of the actions that have been taken to try to get the boat ramp constructed. He said he represents the Sullivan County Sportsmen Club. They are going through legal action now to get the boat ramp. This resolution will help.

Mr. Simonds asked if there will be an access fee when this is established. Mr. Clarke said no. Mr. Simonds said that there are no places around Sunapee where you can put in larger boats. He supports this.

Mr. Raymond said you can launch a boat at the state beach, but you have to pay the state park fee to get in. He said that Lake Sunapee is owned by all of the residents of the state of New Hampshire.

Mr. Simonds was concerned about the access to Route 103. Mr. Clarke said NH DOT (Department of Transportation) looked at the area. It's not ideal, but it's adequate. He said DOT would support a reduction of the speed limit in that area.

Mr. Koloski said he used to access the Sunapee launch, but the wait time and then the long walk to the parking area are not fun. He supports this resolution. He asked about appointing Mr. Clarke as the representative.

Mr. Clarke said he would be willing to be the representative. Mr. McNutt said he has no problem deferring to Mr. Clarke on this issue.

Mayor Lovett asked Mr. Raymond if he would be the backup representative. Mr. Raymond agreed. Mayor Lovett asked him to keep the Council informed on this.

Mayor Lovett said it is her intent that a member of the Council meet with the County Delegation.

Mr. McNutt said he would be happy to support this and to attend meetings on this.

Mayor Lovett asked to add Mr. Clarke as the point of contact to this resolution.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

Resolution 2018-12 to Apply, Accept and Expend \$10,955.36 NH Highway Safety Grant for Claremont DWI Patrols – Public Hearing

The City of Claremont, New Hampshire has applied for and been awarded a New Hampshire Highway Safety Grant for DWI Patrols in the amount of \$10,955.36 for the period ending June 30th, 2018. The City would like to accept and expend the grant funds for their intended purpose.

Mr. Damren read the resolution into the record.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Koloski to adopt Resolution 2018-12 to Apply, Accept and Expend \$10,955.36 NH Highway Safety Grant for Claremont DWI Patrols.

Police Chief Mark Chase said this would allow numerous patrols. The Police Department has used this grant for many years. The patrols will be run from 10 p.m. to 3 a.m.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing.

Bernie Folta, Ward 3, asked about Vermont drivers and recreational use of marijuana. Chief Chase said residency does not matter. Drivers in NH must abide by NH laws. Do not drive while impaired.

Mayor Lovett closed the public hearing.

Roll call vote: motion carried 7-0.

Resolution 2018-14 RSA 79-E Application by Deglace, LLC for 40 Union Street, Parcel 107-13 – Public Hearing

The City Council passed Resolution 2016-11 on July 22, 2015, adopting the provisions of RSA 79-E, Community Revitalization Tax Relief Incentive. On October 10, 2017, the City received an application from Deglace, LLC, seeking property tax relief under the provisions of RSA 79-E as incentive for substantial rehabilitation for property located at 40 Union Street. The Property is located within the City's 79-E Incentive District, as designated by Resolution 2016-11. Deglace, LLC, plans to invest approximately \$159,700.00 to substantially rehabilitate the Property into a business use, featuring commercial space and storage. The property would be eligible for a Community Tax Relief Incentive for a period up to five (5) years, beginning with the completion of the substantial rehabilitation of the Property.

Mr. Simonds read the resolution into the record.

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Mr. Raymond to adopt Resolution 2018-14 RSA 79-E Application by Deglace, LLC for 40 Union Street, Parcel 107-13 as amended.

Nancy Merrill, Planning and Development Director, said that Deglace LLC is a chocolatier that bought the former Esersky's building at 40 Union Street. The building is classified as a 3 on the Historic Archeological Engineering Register, which is the highest rating. It has considerable historic value. The Council needs to determine the public benefit.

Public Benefit: In order to approve this application, the City Council must determine that the development project will create one or more "public benefits" as set forth in RSA 79-E:7, as follows:

1. It enhances the economic vitality of the downtown;
2. It enhances and improves a structure that is culturally or historically important on a local, regional, state, or national level, either independently or within the context of an historic district, town center, or village center in which the building is located;
3. It promotes the preservation and reuse of existing building stock throughout a municipality by the rehabilitation of historic structures, thereby conserving the embodied energy in accordance with energy efficiency guidelines established by the U.S. Secretary of the Interior's Standards for Rehabilitation.
4. It promotes development of municipal centers, providing for efficiency, safety, and a greater sense of community, consistent with RSA 9-B (New Hampshire's "Smart Growth" statute); or,
5. It increases residential housing in urban or town centers.

Ms. Merrill said the covenant is twice the benefit length.

Mr. Damren asked about the additional one (1) year of tax relief for substantial rehabilitation of a qualifying structure listed on the National Register of Historic Places that will be rehabilitated in accordance with the U.S. Secretary of Interior's Standards for Rehabilitation. Ms. Merrill said that does not apply so the resolution should be amended to remove it.

Ms. Merrill said the property would be assessed at the preconstruction value. The covenant begins when they begin construction.

Mayor Lovett said the building is adjacent to the river. She thinks flood insurance should not be conditional. Ms. Merrill said she can check to see if it is in a floodplain. Mayor Lovett said if it is in a floodplain, it needs to stipulate in the resolution that flood insurance is required. Also, reference to city solicitor needs to be removed and replaced with legal review.

Ms. Towle asked if the five years start when the revitalization is completed. Ms. Merrill said yes.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Ms. Merrill said the resolution needs to be amended:

- To remove "additional one (1) year of tax relief for substantial rehabilitation of a qualifying structure listed on the National Register of Historic Places that will be

rehabilitated in accordance with the U.S. Secretary of Interior's Standards for Rehabilitation."

- Change city solicitor to legal review
- Add "if parcel is in a flood plain, flood insurance will be required."

Roll call vote: motion carried 7-0.

NHDES Local Water Source Protection Grant Application for Rice Reservoir

Scott Sweet, Public Works Director, said this grant is for fencing and gates to help protect the City's drinking water at Rice Reservoir. The money will be awarded in January or February. If the City is successful, he will come back to the Council for approval to accept and expend the money; and the work will be done in the spring or summer.

A motion was made by Mr. Raymond and seconded by Mr. Damren to authorize the City Manager or his designees to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to prepare and submit an application for a \$9,000 New Hampshire Department of Environmental Services (NHDES) Local Source Water Protection Grant for the purpose of improvements to the security of the City's water supply infrastructure at the Rice Reservoir.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

Mr. Sweet said this has no impact on the water rates.

Resolution 2018-10 Re-Appropriate City Match for TAP Grant – Public Hearing

The Council, by motion dated September 24, 2014, authorized application for the NH DOT, Transportation Alternatives Program (TAP) grant funding for the purpose of a "Neighborhood Connectivity and Rail Trail Improvement Project" for trail and safety improvements to the City's Rail Trail, including new sidewalks and improved access on East Street, and further, on February 11, 2015, the City accepted the grant and appropriated the City Match for said grant, in the amount of \$119,379.80, to come from fund balance. Said funds were not utilized in 2015 and dropped back into fund balance. This is a request that the City Council reaffirms its acceptance of the grant award and re-appropriates the city match of \$119,379.80 to come from fund balance (to have no impact on the tax rate).

Ms. Walter said this is a re-appropriation. Council had approved to take the City match out of fund balance, however the work never started on the TAP grant. The auditors said that money had technically dropped into fund balance, so they asked to have Council re-approve this.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Resolution 2018-10 Re-Appropriate City Match for TAP Grant.

Mr. Koloski read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Roll call vote: motion carried 7-0.

Resolution 2018-11 Use of Unanticipated Revenue from SAFER Grant – Public Hearing

The City received a three-year award for SAFER funding of three firefighters with said grant now closed. The City, in order to use approved grant funding not expensed by the hired SAFER personnel, was approved and received unanticipated grant funding for two City firefighters prior to the close of the June 30, 2017 budget year. The City wishes to use said funds to retain SAFER personnel through March 31, 2018. This is to raise and appropriate the sum of \$170,000 to be taken from fund balance (to have no impact on the tax rate).

Ms. Walter said the SAFER (Staffing for Adequate Fire & Emergency Response) grant, as of January 2017, had almost \$268,000 left in it and it was originally going to expire March 30, 2017. A lot of this money was left because the firefighters did not take the City's health insurance. We hired two other firefighters after we received the SAFER grant. The remainder of the money (\$170,000) was received and is in the 2018 budget to come from revenue, but it has already dropped into fund balance. This is to appropriate the money from fund balance. This will pay for the firefighters through March 31st.

Mayor Lovett asked if the Fire Chief will reapply for the SAFER Grant. Mr. McNutt said the grants will be for much less money.

Council agreed to make a note to look at this in January to see what the new type of grant would look like and what it would mean to the budget.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Raymond to adopt Resolution 2018-11 Use of Unanticipated Revenue from SAFER Grant.

Mr. Damren read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Roll call vote: motion carried 7-0.

Resolution 2018-13 Accept and Expend \$107,400 LWCF Grant for Playground at Monadnock Park – Public Hearing

The Claremont City Council, on September 14, 2016, adopted a motion authorizing the city manager or his designees to apply for a Land and Water Conservation Fund (LWCF) Grant for major playground renovations at Monadnock Park with the City's match to come from the Parks & Recreation Capital Budget and the Parks improvement allocation from the City Forest Management Fund. The City applied for and was awarded a federal Land and Water Conservation Fund project 50/50 grant by the National Park Service for said playground

renovations in the amount of \$107,400. This is a request that the City Council hereby accepts the Land and Water Conservation Fund project grant funded by the National Park Service in the amount of \$107,400 with \$53,700 to come from the LWCF grant, \$35,000 already in the current 2018 budget, \$17,256 from in-kind labor and equipment and the remaining \$1,444 to come from the City Forest Management Fund.

Mark Brislin, Parks and Recreation Director, said that this will allow replacement of the aging playground in Monadnock Park and to move it to another location which will create more field space.

A motion was made by Mr. Raymond and seconded by Ms. Towle to adopt Resolution 2018-13 Accept and Expend \$107,400 LWCF Grant for Playground at Monadnock Park.

Mr. Raymond read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Roll call vote: motion carried 7-0.

Motion to Transfer \$662.00 Raised from All In Moody Park Bike Race

Mr. Brislin said that Cycle Depot organized this race. This year there were approximately 70 racers.

Mayor Lovett thanked the crew for cleaning up the branches in Moody Park that were knocked down by the storm. She was concerned about the Little Library in the park that when it snows, it would be inaccessible. Mr. Brislin will look into it.

**A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Simonds that
WHEREAS the Claremont Savings Bank Community Center (CSBCC) held an event, the All In at Moody Park Bike Race, to raise funds for the Moody Park Trail Fund and;**

**WHEREAS said event raised \$662.00 for the Moody Park Trail Fund;
The Claremont City Council hereby authorizes the transfer of \$662.00 from General Fund Revenue to the Moody Park Trail Fund, and further authorizes the City Manager or his designee(s) to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this Motion.**

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

Motion to Transfer \$3,185.00 Raised from First Annual Scholarship Golf Scramble

Mr. Brislin said this was the first year for this. Dawn Zombeck was in charge. It was a great success.

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Mr. Raymond that

WHEREAS the Claremont Savings Bank Community Center (CSBCC) held an event, the First Annual Scholarship Golf Scramble, to raise funds for the CSBCC Scholarship Fund and;

WHEREAS said event raised \$3,185.00 for the Scholarship Fund;

The Claremont City Council hereby authorizes the transfer of \$3,185.00 from General Fund Revenue to the CSBCC Scholarship Fund, and further authorizes the City Manager or his designee(s) to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this motion.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

Mr. McNutt gave a heartfelt thanks and appreciation to all directors for bringing in over \$800,000 in grants to the City. Without these grants, there would be an additional almost \$1 added to the tax rate to do those things.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Mr. Damren said the Finance Committee is continuing to look at the establishment of reserve accounts related to water and sewer.

Mr. Pope said the Policy Committee will be working on the lead policy next.

Ms. Towle said at the ZBA (Zoning Board of Adjustment), people are trying to push applications through utilizing the whole setback. People are asking for use of setbacks without surveys which is difficult for the ZBA.

Mayor Lovett asked if the ZBA has done an analysis on the number of variances. Ms. Towle said no.

Ms. Towle said the ZBA has recommended to the Planning and Development Department that when applications are received, that it is strongly recommended that a survey be done and included with the application.

Mayor Lovett said the Amtrak Ad Hoc Committee has created a station host association for people to act as greeters at the Amtrak Station.

Mr. Raymond asked what time Amtrak comes in. Mayor Lovett said 11:45 a.m. and 5:45 p.m. and that Amtrak recommends volunteers get there about one hour before.

Bernie Folta, Ward 3, talked about the timing of the Amtrak schedule and that people might be able to have a nice excursion to Springfield, Massachusetts, and then back to Claremont.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Mayor Lovett said she wouldn't be available on November 21st, so she asked the Councilors to move that meeting to November 29th, 6:30 p.m. Council concurred.

Mayor Lovett asked to change the start time of the November 14th Council meeting to 7 p.m. instead of 6:30. Council concurred.

Mayor Lovett asked for the second reading of Ordinance 557, Naming City-Owned Property be on the 29th agenda.

Ms. Towle would like an update on the opioid situation in Claremont before the end of the year. She would like to know what citizens can do to help. Mayor Lovett asked for this at either the second meeting in November or the first meeting in December.

Mayor Lovett said Mr. Temple had wanted input from Department of Business and Economic Affairs (formerly Department of Resources and Economic Development) regarding the new legislation for tax exemption for new construction.

Mayor Lovett asked about the audit report. Ms. Walter said it may be ready by the end of November, however she has not received a draft yet.

Mayor Lovett asked for an update on the process to dispose of two properties (30 West Pleasant Street and Goulet Avenue) after the buildings have been demolished.

Mayor Lovett asked for a presentation at the end of November regarding the Housing and Economy Conference Mr. McNutt attended.

Mr. Koloski asked for a Boston Post Cane update.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:39 p.m., a motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. Raymond to adjourn.

Voice vote: motion carried 7-0.

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council